Caleb Sponheim, PhD

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AI Lead with a background in UX research and computational neuroscience. I lead organizational AI adoption, design internal agents and automation, and develop corporate training on AI use and product design. My work combines designing and operating AI systems with research into how people understand and use AI.

SKILLS

Research & AI: Quantitative UX research • Statistics & experimental design • AI experience design • AI-assisted research workflows • Programming (Python, R, MATLAB)
Training & Consulting: Corporate training • Curriculum design • Executive workshops
Communication: Public speaking • On-camera • Long-form writing • Cross-functional communication

EXPERIENCE

Senior Experience Specialist, AI Lead **April 2026 - Present**
Senior Experience Specialist January 2026 - April 2026
Experience Specialist July 2023 - January 2026
Nielsen Norman Group (NN/G)

- Led AI direction across NN/G as the first head of NN/G's AI functional group: setting AI processes and policies, advising on org-wide adoption, and building tooling
- Designed, built, and maintained NN/G's institutional AI agent and internal automation platform, with 25+ production automations across every business unit and a chatbot that answers employee questions
- Developed Designing AI Experiences (NN/G's top-enrolling course since its launch), along with Research w/ AI and Practical AI for Professionals; trained 1,000+ professionals and delivered enterprise workshops for multinational clients
- Served as primary AI subject-matter expert at NN/G; quoted as an expert source in TIME, Axios, CNET, and Futurism on AI behavior and design
- Delivered keynote talks on AI at international conferences "Humanized AI Is Distracting Your Customers" at UX on the Beach 2026 (Venice, Italy); "Humanized AI is a Trap" at WaysConf 2025 (Krakow, Poland).
- Mentored two junior employees and managed an intern

Research Scientist **August 2017 - July 2023**
University of Chicago

- Used generative ML approaches to uncover links between brain activity and movement; co-author on six peer-reviewed publications (700+ citations, Google Scholar)
- Collaborated with 10+ researchers and engineers to build a brain-machine interface enabling paralyzed participants to control virtual and robotic limbs with brain activity
- Secured $300k+ three-year engineering fellowship from the Department of Defense
- Delivered recommendations on the lifespan of brain implants by analyzing 6000+ datasets

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Computational Neuroscience *University of Chicago, 2023*
B.A. Psychology *Grinnell College, 2015*